

Agricultural Entrepreneurship

Science

May, 2026



Agricultural Entrepreneurship (A07950)

Short Title: Agricultural Entrepreneurship
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Business
Author RODOWD
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

The aim of this module is to introduce the student to the principles and techniques of developing off-farm enterprises, from concept stage to small business creation.

Programmes

AGRI-0014 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

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Indicative Content

- The entrepreneurial process: profile of an entrepreneur; intrapreneurship; small business ownership
- Idea generation; creativity and innovation strategies
- Establishing the enterprise: legal structures & start-up procedures; gaining a competitive advantage; mission statement & SWOT analysis
- Management issues: choosing a location and premises; sources of finance; staffing issues
- Managing an enterprise: effective leadership; managerial decision making
- The business plan: writing the plan; funding proposal; detailed projections
- Pitching the business idea: presenting the business idea for funding purposes

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Analyse the entrepreneurial process and apply creative and innovation strategies to explore entrepreneurial opportunities.
2. Analyse and discuss the necessary skills to develop and manage a successful small business.
3. Analyse and discuss the problems faced by small enterprises from sourcing finance to choosing a location for their business.
4. Design and write a successful business plan.
5. Communicate the business idea effectively and pitch the idea for funding purposes.
6. Differentiate and apply theories of leadership and decision making in a small business context.
7. Illustrate comprehensively how to establish an enterprise including legal structures, start-up procedures and regulatory issues.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Case studies.
- Class discussions.
- Videos.
- Guest speakers.
- Site visits.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	30%	2,3,6,7
<i>Project</i>	45%	1,4
<i>Presentation</i>	25%	5

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to carry out critical thinking.

40%-49%: Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem solving.

50%-59%: Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject.

60%-69%: Demonstrate skilled and sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically discuss in an effective way. Good critical thinking and a high level of competence and efficiency in theoretical areas of this subject.

70%-100%: All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- O'Hara, B. *Entrepreneurship in Ireland*. 1st ed.. Dublin: Gill and Macmillan, 2011.